

- ▶ **Reporting:** After the evaluation of the play test, the designer reports the design changes to the art, animation and programming team to follow and iterate accordingly. It is important to cross check bugs between various versions and different play testers.

Types of testing needed for video games

Video games need some special types of testing which usual software may/may not need. Following are the types of testing required for games:

Functionality Testing: This testing requires testing of general game functions and gameplay and does not need any technical expertise. Usually done by external play testers, this type of testing is done during earlier phases of the game development concentrating upon revising game mechanics and gameplay.

- ▶ **Compliance testing:** This type of testing is crucial for console development as console platforms have strict guidelines for technical requirements. Microsoft, Sony, Nintendo all have some sort of technical requirement checklist to comply to. Some other tests during this testing include formatting of standard error messages, legal authentication of copyrighted material (if used), testing for objectionable content and memory card data handling.
- ▶ **Compatibility testing:** Here the game is tested on a set of platforms listed by the publisher for any compatibility issues regarding hardware.
- ▶ **Localisation testing:** If game is to be released worldwide or at more than one country, it is important to test if the game sounds, UI, text, dialogues, symbols etc are properly changed and localized.
- ▶ **Soak testing:** Since game is a form of interactive entertainment, this form of testing becomes very important for games. Since a game can be left at idle, exit, paused state by the player, the game has to be tested for memory leaks and rounding errors. This technique is called soak testing.
- ▶ **Regression testing:** This is used to test if fixing of one bug lead to another bug or not.
- ▶ **Load testing:** In case of MMORPGS and other online games like World of Warcraft, this type of testing is important to test load on the server.
- ▶ **Multi-player testing:** This type of testing is essential for games that support multi-player mode. The game is tested for different types for network configurations, synchronization of game variables etc.